

REEM ABDELMAGIED

Development Evaluation & Public Policy Specialist

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CAREER SUMMARY

I'm a development evaluation and public policy professional with 8+ years of experience across Egypt, Lebanon, Tunisia, and the wider MENA region. My work spans programme evaluation and MEAL, policy design, mixed-methods research, and capacity building — from evaluating Egypt's first National Migration Strategy against the OECD-DAC criteria to designing the MEAL frameworks now used across national action plans. I currently serve as Senior Researcher at Egypt's National Coordinating Committee (NCCPIM&TIP), where I lead the drafting of the country's 2nd National Migration Strategy and review donor-funded projects worth over €9M before implementation. Alongside the policy work, I've stayed close to the field: leading youth empowerment programmes reaching 500+ technical-school students in migration-prone governorates, training 35 young community leaders, and managing multi-site data collection teams for an EU-funded national study in Lebanon.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **EU Programme Engagement.** Drafted the funded project proposals submitted by Egypt's NCCPIM&TIP under the Egypt–EU Strategic Partnership on migration (€200M envelope), and reviewed ICMPD-prepared proposals (€4.5M per project) to ensure alignment with Egypt's national migration policy prior to Committee approval. Currently serve as institutional reviewer for funded migration projects implemented in Egypt.
- **MEAL & Results-Based Management.** Designed Egypt's 4th National Action Plan MEAL framework, which received the highest national benchmark to date (85% Cabinet-assessed maturity rating). Institutionalised the Results Framework and Theory of Change models now used across migration-related action plans.
- **Migration Strategy Design.** Lead drafter of Egypt's 2nd National Strategy for Combating Irregular Migration and Migrant Smuggling (2027–2036), endorsed by the full Committee membership representing 30+ national entities, with only minor revisions requested across all axes. The strategy is aligned with the Global Compact for Migration and the EU–Egypt cooperation framework. Previously evaluated the 1st National Strategy (2016–2026) using the OECD-DAC criteria and Theory of Change.
- **Academic Recognition.** Global Campus of Human Rights Award (2023) as the top-ranked graduate of the joint European Master's programme in Democracy and Human Rights (Saint Joseph University of Beirut / Global Campus of Human Rights).
- **International Representation.** Member of the Egyptian delegation to the UNTOC Working Group on Smuggling of Migrants (Vienna, 2025 and 2026 — two consecutive years), delivering Egypt's national statement in 2025 and contributing to its preparation and translation in 2026.
- **Law Enforcement Capacity Building.** Designed and delivered specialised training programmes for law enforcement officials on irregular migration, migrant smuggling, and counter-trafficking, as part of a multi-institutional capacity-building mandate covering the Ministry of Interior, border management units, and judicial and prosecution personnel.
- **Stakeholder Coordination at Scale.** Coordinate substantive inputs across 30+ national entities — ministries, regulatory bodies, and human rights councils — for migration governance, GCM reporting, and donor-funded programme cycles, including the production of consolidated stakeholder analyses and institutional mappings.
- **Regional Sustainable Development.** Independent expert contributor to the Arab Sustainable Development Vision 2045 (UN-ESCWA / League of Arab States), adopted at the Baghdad Summit 2025, including the development of impact-measurement indicators for regional development priorities.
- **International Compliance Reporting.** Contributed to Egypt's reports to the Global Compact for Migration, the Universal Periodic Review (UPR), and the International Convention on the Protection of the Rights of All Migrant Workers and Their Families.

EDUCATION

PhD Researcher — International Relations and International Law

2024 – 2028 (ongoing)

Cairo University

GPA: 3.73. Doctoral research focuses on migration governance and the role of foreign aid in shaping irregular migration patterns (2009–2025; OECD destination focus), and includes an original theoretical contribution developed under the working title "institutional filter model".

Master's in Democracy and Human Rights (European Programme)

2022 – 2023

Saint Joseph University of Beirut / Global Campus of Human Rights

GPA: 3.43. Top-ranked graduate of the cohort and recipient of the Global Campus of Human Rights Award. Thesis: "Shifts in the Determinants of Irregular Emigration of Tunisians" — catalogued in the OHCHR Library, Geneva (DOI: 10.25330/2807). Coursework: International Humanitarian Law, International Human Rights Law and protection mechanisms in MENA, comparative constitutional systems, transition processes in MENA, vulnerable persons and groups, and the legacy of colonialism.

Master's in Political Science — Environmental Peacebuilding

2018 – 2021

Cairo University

GPA: 3.5. Thesis: "Repercussions of Natural Disasters on Armed Internal Conflict Settlement" (graded Excellent). Coursework included comparative political systems, conflict studies, international cooperation, research methods, and water in international relations.

Bachelor's in Political Science (Major) / Public Administration (Minor)

2014 – 2018

Cairo University

Grade: Very Good. Dissertation: "Determinants of University Students' Orientation Towards Conservative Ideology".

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Researcher & Member of the Technical Secretariat — NCCPIM&TIP, Egypt

02/2024 – Present

Donor-Funded Migration Programmes — Review, Coordination, and Implementation

- Serve as institutional reviewer for funded migration projects before their implementation in Egypt, ensuring alignment with the national migration strategy and on-the-ground priorities. Portfolio currently includes COMPASS, MPRR, ICMPD II, and other interventions covering labour mobility, anti-smuggling, and migrant protection.
- Drafted the funded project proposals submitted by the Committee under the Egypt–EU Strategic Partnership on migration (€200M envelope), in coordination with the relevant line ministries.
- Reviewed ICMPD-prepared project proposals (€4.5M per project) and led their adaptation to align with Egypt's national migration policy, with the final adjustments accepted by ICMPD prior to Committee endorsement.
- Manage funded portfolios totalling €9M+ at the implementation level. Responsibilities cover the full project cycle: WBS, LogFrames, work plans, budgets, risk registers, Budget vs. Actual reports, and PRAG-compliant Single Form Reporting.
- Draft funding proposals and partnership agreements for international donors (ICMPD, U.S. State Department, among others), and evaluate donor-proposed projects for alignment with national priorities.

Migration Governance, Strategy Design, and Evidence-Based Policy

- Lead drafter of Egypt's 2nd National Strategy for Combating Irregular Migration and Migrant Smuggling (2027–2036). Produced the full zero-draft and substantive content of all strategic axes; the draft was reviewed by the Technical Secretariat, revised by the Committee Chairperson, and endorsed by the full Committee membership representing 30+ national entities (including the Ministries of Foreign Affairs, Manpower, Social Solidarity, Interior, Justice, Emigration and Egyptian Expatriates, and Education), with only minor revisions requested across all axes.
- Conducted a full evaluation of Egypt's 1st National Strategy (2016–2026) using the OECD-DAC Evaluation Criteria, producing structured analytical outputs covering relevance, coherence, effectiveness, efficiency, impact, and sustainability, alongside evidence-based recommendations for institutional reform.
- Contributed to Egypt's international compliance reports for the Global Compact for Migration, the Universal Periodic Review, and the Migrant Workers Convention. Prepare the Committee's quarterly performance reports on national migration efforts for the Presidency and the Cabinet.

Stakeholder Analysis, MEAL, and Research Coordination

- Design and operationalise MEAL frameworks, Results Frameworks, Theory of Change models, and M&E plans for national action plans and donor-funded interventions; coordinate multi-source data collection across 30+ entities.
- Produce stakeholder mappings and institutional analyses covering governmental bodies, donors, EU services, international and national organisations, civil society, the private sector, and training institutions engaged in migration governance.
- Coordinate national mixed-methods studies on trafficking and irregular migration in cooperation with CAPMAS and the National Centre for Social and Criminological Research.

Training, Awareness, and Youth Mobilisation

- Designed and delivered capacity-building training for government officials on combating irregular migration and migrant smuggling, including officers of the Ministry of Interior, border-management personnel, social workers, doctors, and protection focal points. Cumulative reach: **500+ officials trained** across multiple national institutions, with training content covering international protection standards, anti-smuggling, gender-sensitive approaches, and PSEA.
- Designed the Committee's youth-awareness approach on irregular migration risks and legal alternatives (regular labour mobility, education, and vocational pathways), including an interactive educational toolkit deployed across migration-prone governorates.
- Designed and led the **Youth Ambassadors initiative** under the RAIM project, directing its full cycle — from the selection and training of 35 young leaders to the rollout of 30+ community-based awareness interventions across migration-prone governorates.
- Oversaw an empowerment programme reaching 500+ technical-school students across 25 schools in migration-prone governorates.
- Built strategic partnerships with Haya Karima, the Life Makers Foundation, and Maspero Media Academy for community outreach and locally-led implementation.

International Representation

- Member of the Egyptian delegation to the UNTOC Working Group on Smuggling of Migrants (Vienna, October 2025 and June 2026 — two consecutive years), delivering Egypt's national statement to the Working Group in 2025 and contributing to its preparation and translation in 2026, within the framework of the Conference of the States Parties to the United Nations Convention against Transnational Organized Crime.

Independent Consultant Expert — UN-ESCWA — Arab Sustainable Development Vision 2045, Beirut 2022

- Selected as an independent expert, alongside senior policymakers, academics, and civil society representatives, to contribute to the foundational drafting of the Arab Sustainable Development Vision 2045.
- Took part in high-level expert dialogues in Beirut, drafted key revisions, and developed impact-measurement indicators to ensure the document's strategic clarity, operational alignment, and consistency with Arab development priorities.
- **Key Achievement:** The Vision was officially adopted at the 2025 Baghdad Summit as the guiding regional sustainable development framework.

Senior Project Manager (part-time) / Country Coordinator (part-time) — URDA, Lebanon 11/2023 – 07/2024

- As Senior Project Manager (02/2024 – 07/2024): directed humanitarian aid projects for Palestinian refugee families in Egypt; managed planning, budgets, logistics, and stakeholder coordination; and designed project reporting and progress-tracking systems. Projects delivered medical, educational, and housing support to 5,000+ refugees, 75% of whom were women and children.
- As Country Coordinator (11/2023 – 01/2024): managed logistics, financial, and administrative processes for humanitarian aid initiatives, and coordinated the dispatch of 12 aid trucks to Gaza within 3 months, in collaboration with INGOs and regional NGOs.

Crisis Management & Public Policy Consultant — State Ministry of Information — Minister's Technical Office, Cairo 05/2020 – 03/2022

- Monitored international, regional, and domestic developments on an ongoing basis for the Minister's Technical Office, authoring the periodic analytical reports submitted to the Minister — including policy recommendations and crisis-response options that informed national decision-making.

- Co-authored the 3rd National Action Plan to Combat Illegal Migration (2021–2023) and the 2nd National Human Trafficking Strategy (2021–2026); drafted Egypt's National Media Strategy 2020 and the crisis-media policies officially circulated to national outlets.
- As a member of the national crisis committee, produced policy papers and analytical assessments on six active regional conflicts — including the Libyan armed conflict, the Sudan civil war, the Egyptian–Ethiopian dispute over the Nile, Eastern Mediterranean tensions, and the Yemeni armed conflict — which informed national foreign policy positions.
- **Programme Manager — African Media Professionals Programme.** Directed the design and delivery of training programmes for journalists and official spokespersons from across African states on the media coverage of political, social, and development issues — delivered in partnership with the EU, including the 42nd African Anglophone Media Course.
- Led the Office's cooperation with the EU on media-development initiatives targeting journalists and media professionals, and applied SPSS, Power BI, Tableau, and MaxQDA for the data-driven analysis underpinning national media and policy development. Partnered with the EU and UNICEF on initiatives including the South Sudan Media Professionals Programme.

Research and Programme Officer — Climate Change, Migration & Peacebuilding — Arab Institute for Human Rights, Tunis
03/2023 – 06/2023

- Conducted mixed-methods research on the climate–migration–peacebuilding nexus in Tunisia and the wider MENA region; drafted concept notes for two environmental projects applying climate-justice and nature-based solutions frameworks.
- Designed monitoring frameworks and performance indicators using Theory of Change and LogFrame approaches; contributed to the design and delivery of the Annual Regional Human Rights Training Course.

MEAL and Research Specialist (short-term contract) — Tunisian Institute for Peace and Conflict Studies, Tunis
02/2023 – 03/2023

- Designed and implemented MEAL frameworks for the Mo.sca.clim. Kairouan project, which evaluated the societal and gender-specific impacts of climate change and natural disasters; produced evaluation outputs applying OECD-DAC criteria.
- Delivered capacity-building training for 18 Tunisian NGO representatives on environmental policy advocacy and Results-Based Management.

Human Security Researcher — European Centre for Counterterrorism and Intelligence Studies, Germany
07/2020 – 12/2020

- Authored analytical reports on terrorism and human-security trends in Europe for policy use; edited and published thematic content for the organisation's website.

FIELD PROJECTS & ADVOCACY — LEBANON (2022 – 2023)

Research and field-coordination activities undertaken alongside graduate studies in Lebanon.

- **EU-Funded National Research on School Dropouts in Lebanon** (Ministry of Education / EU, 2023) — Lead Research Methodologist & Field Operations Manager. Designed the full mixed-methods research methodology for a national study examining the impact of the economic crisis on school dropout among Lebanese and Syrian refugee children. The methodology was adopted by 20+ researchers deployed across all Lebanese regions. Drafted the research problem statement, literature review, and methodological framework; trained field researchers on survey instruments and focus-group protocols; coordinated and supervised multi-site data collection.
- **"Baby Not Bride" — Awareness & Advocacy Campaign Against Child Marriage** (ABAAD NGO, 2022). Co-designed and helped implement an advocacy campaign targeting refugee families and religious leaders in Syrian camps and impoverished Lebanese areas, raising awareness on the risks of child marriage. The campaign reached approximately 10,000 people through community outreach sessions and the mobilisation of local leaders.
- **Psychosocial Support Programme for Children** (Basmeh & Zeitooneh and Clown Me In NGOs, 2023). Drafted the project concept note, conducted needs-assessment research, identified suitable arts-based psychosocial interventions, developed the budget and implementation plan, and coordinated partnerships with local NGOs to deliver emotional-

support programmes for Syrian refugee and Lebanese children in Bourj Hammoud affected by the Beirut explosion, the Syrian war, and Lebanon's economic crisis.

EARLIER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (2015 – 2020)

Paid research, analytical, and editorial roles held during and immediately following undergraduate studies. As Sustainable Development Researcher at Almaadi Group for Investment, Saudi Arabia (2018, following graduation), supported the group's strategic-development work for the Mecca Area Authority under Saudi Vision 2030. As Human Security Researcher at the Arab Center for Research and Studies, Egypt (2017 during undergraduate studies, and 2019 following graduation), produced analytical research on climate security and Gulf affairs. Additional roles: Human Security Researcher at Alkhalij Foundation for Press and Publishing, UAE (2019–2020); Editorial Assistant and Head of the Turkish Affairs Department at Algiwar Press, UAE (2019); Research Assistant at Al-Hewar Center for Political and Media Studies (2018); Research Assistant at the State Information Service, Egypt (2017); Social Researcher at Gisir Institution for Survey Research (2016); and Newspaper Editor at Albawaba News and Sout El-Omma Newspaper (2015–2016). Full details available upon request.

COMMISSIONED RESEARCH & POLICY WRITING (paid, invitation-based)

- **King Salman Center for Relief and Humanitarian Aid — International Journal in Humanitarian Studies (2020–2024):** commissioned analytical articles on humanitarian crises, human rights law, climate change, and non-traditional security threats in the MENA region.
- **Alkhalij Foundation for Press and Publishing — UAE (2019–2020):** commissioned articles on climate change, regional security, and Gulf affairs.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT & CERTIFICATIONS

- Specialised Workshop on Gender, Human Rights, and Reporting on TIP & SOM — UNODC ROMENA, Morocco (October 2025).
- Project Management — Advanced Scheduling and Risk Management — The American University in Cairo (2024).
- Google Data Analytics Certificate — Tableau, SQL, and Data Visualisation (2022).
- Economic and Social Planning — Arab Planning Institute, Kuwait (2021).
- Digital Marketing Certificate — Udacity (2021).
- Cybersecurity Fundamentals — CLS Learning Solutions (2021).

TRAINING & FACILITATION EXPERIENCE (SELECTED)

- Facilitator — Quantitative Empirical Research, Egyptian Enterprise Center for Research and Studies (July–August 2022).
- Facilitator — Climate and Peacebuilding workshop, Dialogue Project on the Human Fraternity Document (Phases 1 & 2), Mediterranean Youth Foundation, Ministry of Youth and Sports, and the United Nations Alliance of Civilizations (March–July 2022).
- Facilitator — How to Write Public Policy Papers and Risk Assessment Papers, International Consultations Group (May 2022) and Faculty of Economic Studies and Political Science, Beni Suef University (April 2022).
- Facilitator — Skills for Political and Economic Research Qualification, Faculty of Economics and Administration, 6th October University (May 2022).
- Facilitator — Sustainable Development and the Relationship Between Environmental Disasters, Climate Change, and Conflicts, 6th October University (March 2022).
- Facilitator — Climate Change and Its Relationship to Peace and Conflict, UEDP (November 2021).

MEMBERSHIPS, AFFILIATIONS & VOLUNTEER ENGAGEMENTS

- Member — Environmental Peacebuilding Association (since December 2021), launched by UN Environment and the Environmental Law Institute in 2018.

- Member — AU-Yaatemopa (April 2021 – 2022).
- Communication and Advocacy Officer (volunteer) — Ma'aky Initiative / Together for Development NGO, Egypt (10/2021 – 04/2022): developed PR strategies and campaigns aimed at combating violence against women, built partner relationships, and managed social media accounts.
- Volunteer — Ministry of Youth and Sports cultural activities (2016).
- AC Member — EPM (Euro-Mediterranean Parliamentary) Model, Faculty of Economics and Political Science, Cairo University (2015–2016).
- Participant — African Union Simulation Model, Institute of African Studies & Research (sponsored by the Ministry of Youth, the State Information Service, and Cairo University, August 2015).
- Founder — "Impact" student family at the Faculty of Economics and Political Science, Cairo University (2015).

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Programme Evaluation & MEAL.** OECD-DAC Evaluation Criteria; Theory of Change; Logical Frameworks (LogFrames); Results-Based Management (RBM); performance indicator design; Data Quality Assessment (DQA); Contribution Analysis; Most Significant Change (MSC); Utilisation-Focused Evaluation.
- **Migration Governance & EU Policy.** Labour and irregular migration governance; EU migration cooperation frameworks (Talent Partnerships, GAMM, Pact on Migration and Asylum); Global Compact for Migration; UPR, UNTOC and Palermo Protocols; Team Europe approach; bilateral mobility agreements and consular cooperation.
- **Stakeholder Analysis & Coordination.** Multi-entity coordination across 30+ governmental and quasi-governmental Egyptian bodies; institutional mappings; interest and influence analysis; inter-ministerial coordination; South-South and EU–MENA cooperation; conflict-sensitivity and do-no-harm.
- **EU Programme Cycle Management.** PRAG-compliant programme management; Single Form Reporting; WBS, risk registers, budgets, work plans, and exit strategies; Budget vs. Actual (BvA) and burn-rate monitoring; IATI compliance; review and clearance of EU- and IOM-funded migration projects in Egypt.
- **Donor & Resource Mobilisation.** Proposal writing and grant management across a multi-donor portfolio, donor negotiations, co-financing arrangements, and contribution to the Egypt–EU Strategic Partnership (€200M).
- **Mixed-Methods Research.** Quantitative and qualitative research design; survey instruments; key informant interviews; focus group discussions; participatory and rapid assessments; multi-country fieldwork coordination; literature reviews; comparative policy analysis; cost-effectiveness analysis.
- **Data Analytics & Visualisation.** SPSS, Stata, EViews, NVivo, MaxQDA; Tableau, Power BI, Advanced Excel, KoboToolbox, SQL; statistical forecasting, real-time dashboards.
- **Capacity Building & Facilitation.** Workshop and training design; Training of Trainers (ToT); training-manual development; institutional capacity assessments; PSEA; gender- and child-sensitive approaches; youth mobilisation and awareness campaign design.

LANGUAGES

Arabic — Native (C2) **English** — Professional Working Proficiency (B2) **French** — Elementary (A2)

PUBLICATIONS & REFERENCES

Selected publications accessible via my ResearchGate profile (reem.abdelmagied20). Master's thesis catalogued in the OHCHR Library, Geneva, under DOI 10.25330/2807. Professional references available upon request.